

PROPAGANDA AND POLITICS IN THE Space Age

THE COLD WAR

From 1947–1991, the Cold War overshadowed global politics. In the aftermath of World War II, two superpowers emerged: the US and the USSR, now called Russia. Together with their allied states, known respectively as the Western and Soviet blocs, they struggled for political, economic, and cultural dominance. The two sides had different ideas about the role women should play in postwar society. In the US, which

needed women to return to the home after the war in order to create employment for men, propaganda promoted the idea of the happy housewife and mother. In contrast, in the USSR, which had suffered heavy losses in the war, women were portrayed as key workers in the communist state. The 1936 Soviet Constitution enshrined equal rights for women and both the USSR and the rest of the Soviet bloc

► Space pioneer

Valentina Tereshkova became the first woman to travel into space in her capsule, Vostok 6. She clocked in more hours than all US astronauts combined to that date, orbiting the earth 48 times over three days.

